

ing, you will see various options for inputs; make sure Aux, Microphone and Line In are checked. Click OK, and you will see the options you selected displayed in the Recording Control dialog.



Check the box corresponding to the input you want to record from

If you're going to be using the Microphone to record your sound, check the Select box below Microphone. Repeat the same procedure for when you have to record using the line-in port on the sound card. Since you can only select one input at a time, you will have to repeat this procedure once you're finished using, say, the Microphone and now want to record using the line-in input.

6.1.2 Keep It Quiet

When recording using the microphone, you will have to make sure to cut down on ambient noise. Some microphones are extremely sensitive, and might even pick up the whirring of the CPU fan. You should even switch off ceiling fans, and make sure all windows and doors are closed.

If you can, block the gaps between the floor and the door(s) with cloth to keep ambient sound to a minimum. Also block off gaps in windows.

Next, you should be concerned about the placement of the microphone. In order to reduce or avoid any echo or reflected sounds, make sure that the immediate surroundings have irregular surfaces (basically anything but blank walls). A soft rug hanging on the wall, or a bookshelf, or even sticking the egg trays on the wall are good deterrents to echoes. The simple physics is that irregular surfaces do not reflect sound well, and thus prevent you from getting a dull-sounding recording. Also, try not to face a wall at a 90 degree angle—a 60 to 45 degree angle will send any